

Global Digital Assets

Riot Platforms Inc

Rating

Outperform

Price Target



35.00 USD (30.00 OLD)

11 August 2026

Price Target Change

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RIOT: \$9.1Bn frontier lab deal and 1GW LOI (New PT \$35)

Riot signed a \$9.1Bn 20 year co-location lease (191 IT-MW at Rockdale) with the world's leading frontier lab - (reported by [Bloomberg](#) to be Anthropic). Riot also signed a non-binding LOI with a single tenant for the 1GW Corsicana site. We have repeatedly heard from within the industry, Riot's 1.7GW power assets across two sites (Rockdale and Corsicana) are some of the best sites for building AI data centers - interconnect approved (not subject to ERCOT batch process), urban proximity-low latency. The announcements today lay out a clear scale up path to monetizing these assets with strong revenue visibility. We update our estimates for the deals announced and move price target to \$35 (vs \$30 earlier).

Given the political backlash to data centers (including recent Texas audit announcement), approved front of the meter sites are increasingly rare and would find ready takers. This has further pushed lease pricing power in favour of the landlords. Recent colocation deals have been priced 25-33% higher than deals just a few months back. Riot's recent deal falls at the upper end of this range at \$2.4Mn/IT-MW for a 20-year lease.

Riot announced Morgan Stanley has approved a \$573Mn interim facility against an estimated capex range of \$2.1-\$2.3Bn. Riot disclosed an equity component of \$30-280 Mn (net of \$180Mn redeployed from AMD lease term loan). Riot's balance sheet liquidity remained strong with \$0.5Bn of cash, \$0.7Bn of Bitcoin held. Riot continues selling its Bitcoin production to fund the equity portion of the data center buildout.

We update our model to reflect RIOT's recent financial results and 191 IT-MW AI contract with frontier AI lab. We rate RIOT Outperform PT \$35 (vs \$30 earlier). The increased target price reflects improved economics for RIOT's recent 191 IT-MW deal vs our estimates - both in terms of revenue yield and margin conversion.

Investment Implications

We rate RIOT Outperform PT \$35

Reported EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
RIOT (USD)	(1.95)	0.21	(1.24)	Revenues (M)	647.43	725.03	961.69	--	Reported P/E (x)	(10.0)	90.6	(15.7)
OLD	--	1.36	(0.77)									

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our [Global Research Disclosure Website](#).

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Close Date	10 Aug 2026			
RIOT Close Price (USD)	19.40			
Price Target (USD)	35.00			
Upside/(Downside)	80%			
52-Week Range	30.32/11.04			
SPX	7,753.11			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	NA			
Market Cap (USD) (M)	7,280			
EV (USD) (M)	7,952			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	53.1	(7.5)	31.1	74.6
SPX (%)	13.3	2.3	11.7	21.3
Relative (%)	39.9	(9.8)	19.4	53.3

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



DETAILS

Contract with frontier AI lab: RIOT has signed a contract with a leading frontier AI lab for 191 IT-MW at Rockdale campus with a TCV of \$9.1 Bn over a 20-year term (2 five year extension options).

- **ARR:** The lease will contribute \$457 Mn in ARR and \$365-411 Mn in average annual NOI.
- **Deal economics:** The NOI range is 80-90% expected to contribute \$7.3-8.2Bn over the deal term. The lease includes annual escalators on base rent.
- **Capex and design:** Between \$11-12 Mn/IT-MW cumulatively reaching \$2.1-2.3 Bn. The design and architecture has been finalized with Yates Construction as general contractor.
- **Financing:** The company expects debt financing in 80-90% LTC range (\$1.7-2.1 Bn). The \$573 Mn interim facility from Morgan Stanley will allow early procurement of long lead equipment.
- **Delivery schedule:** Phase 1 (96 IT-MW) delivery is scheduled for Dec-2027e and full deployment in Jun-2028e.

AMD contract progress: RIOT has delivered 25 IT-MW capacity to AMD on time and on budget in May 2026, with AMD operating the site since Jan 2026. AMD exercised expansion option for 25 IT-MW in Apr 2026 taking the total contracted capacity to 50 IT-MW at Rockdale - construction is ongoing with first phase delivery expected in year end - CY26e and final delivery in May-2027e. AMD also has an expansion option for upto an additional 150 IT-MW at Rockdale.

Uncontracted capacity (additional capacity at Rockdale, 1 GW at Corsicana): Management has highlighted that Rockdale still has additional capacity. The Corsicana site (full 756 IT-MW, 1000 MW gross) is currently under a non-binding LOI with a single tenant. The company is undertaking initial development and critical path procurement of long lead items to de-risk execution at the site.

Revenue visibility: The 2 signed leases at Rockdale (AMD and Frontier lab) across represent \$9.8Bn in TCV, and are expected to generate \$520Mn ARR (AMD contribution \$63.6 Mn) with \$416-462 Mn average annual NOI (AMD contribution \$51 Mn). A signed lease for the Corsicana site could represent a significant further increase in ARR.

Expanding financing landscape: Further, the financing landscape has eased out with wider array of financial lenders with flexible structures and lower cost of funding. As Semis players are participating directly in the data center/Neocloud market, we are seeing new pools of financial capital underwriting the data center buildout. For e.g NVIDIA (covered by Stacy Rasgon) directly leasing from AI infra developers (recent HUT leasing deal) and the \$500Bn independent financing platform announced yesterday (Blackrock, Blackstone, Brookfield, Goldman Sachs, KKR). The net result is longer lease terms, better terms and third party lender support.

MODEL UPDATE

We update our model to reflect RIOT's recent financial results and 191 IT MW AI contract with frontier AI lab. We rate RIOT Outperform PT \$35 (vs \$30 earlier). The increased target price reflects improved economics for RIOT's recent 191 IT MW deal vs our estimates - both in terms of revenue yield and margin conversion. In our earlier model, we assumed 400 IT MW contracted capacity for RIOT (by CY30E) at \$1.5Mn/ IT MW average annual revenue yield and 80% EBITDA margins. After accounting for RIOT's recent AI contract with frontier AI lab, we now model 391 IT MW contracted capacity at \$2.2Mn/ IT MW average annual revenue yield and 84% EBITDA margins. We rate RIOT Outperform PT \$35. AI colocation business contributes 84% of our target EV, while Bitcoin mining (11%) and Bitcoin HODL (5%) contributes the remaining 16%.

We continue to value RIOT using an SOTP approach:

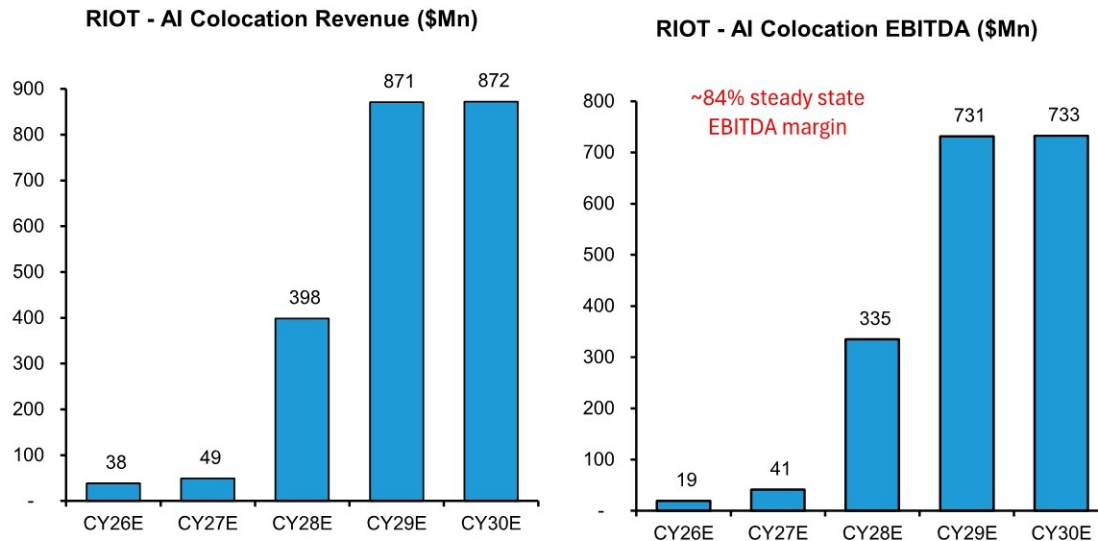
(i) AI colocation business: We expect RIOT to deliver 391 IT MW billable capacity by CY30E. Out of this 241 IT MW is already contracted at the Rockdale site (50 IT MW to AMD and 191 IT MW to frontier AI lab). Further, we assume additional 150 IT MW capacity contract with the same economics as the 191 IT MW contract announced recently. For the buildouts we assume RIOT raises incremental \$3.7Bn in secured financing, representing ~90% of project capex (in-line with similar projects backed by investment grade credit).

By 2030E, we expect RIOT to generate ~\$0.9Bn in colocation revenue (vs ~\$0.6Bn modeled earlier) and ~\$0.7Bn (vs ~\$0.5Bn modeled earlier) in AI EBITDA. We expect ~84% blended steady state EBITDA margin for RIOT's AI colocation business. We value RIOT at 21x EV/ one year forward EBITDA on CY30E EBITDA to arrive at \$15Bn EV for CY29E. We discount it to arrive at our target EV of ~\$12Bn (12 month target).

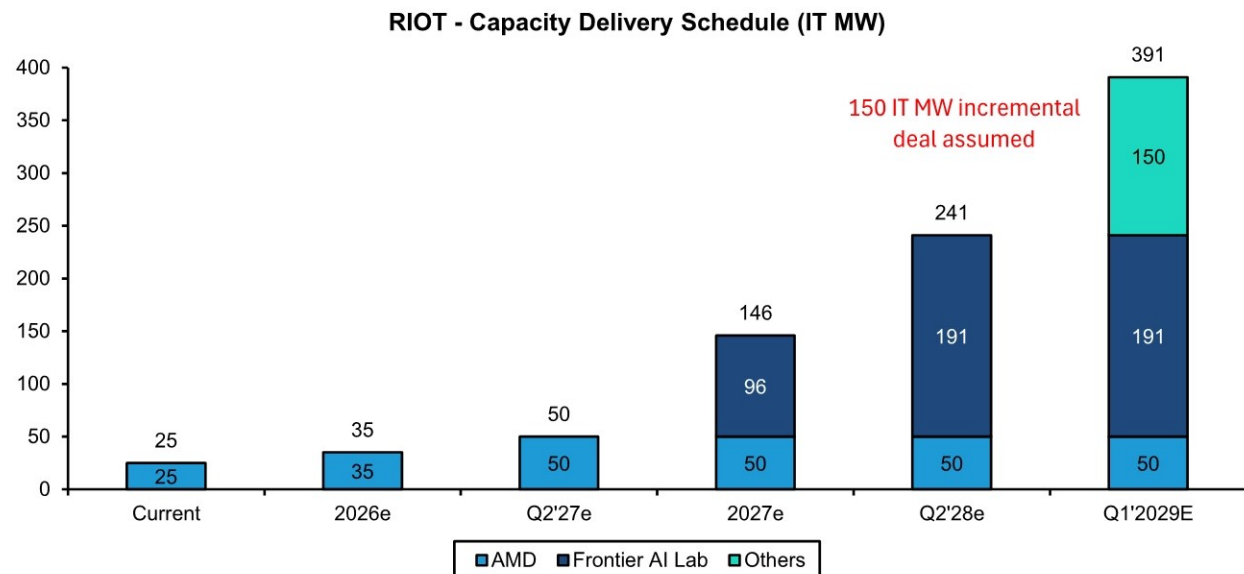
(ii) Bitcoin mining business: We value RIOT's Bitcoin mining business at 5x EV/EBITDA'27E. RIOT's Bitcoin business (44 EH/s installed capacity) could help RIOT in redeploying excess free cashflow to fund equity portion of their data center buildout. We value RIOT's mining business at \$1.7Bn (5x EV/EBITDA'27E).

(iii) BTC Holdings NAV: RIOT holds 11,380 Bitcoin, representing \$0.7Bn liquidity at \$65K/BTC. RIOT has been selling its Bitcoin production and reserves to fund the data center capex.

EXHIBIT 1: RIOT - AI revenue and EBITDA ramp-up



Source: Company filings, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **We expect RIOT to deliver 391 IT MW by CY29E**

Source: Company filings and guidance, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **We rate RIOT Outperform PT\$35**

\$Mn	CY24	CY25	CY26E	CY27E	CY28E	CY29E	CY30E
Total Adjusted EBITDA (\$Mn)	6	164	136	376	637	1,276	842
Mining EBITDA (\$Mn)	6	164	117	335	303	545	109
Adjusted EBITDA Margin (%)	2%	25%	17%	37%	43%	58%	16%
AI Colocation EBITDA (\$Mn)			19	41	335	731	733
Adjusted EBITDA Margin (%)			50%	84%	84%	84%	84%

RIOT SOTP	Valuation Methodology	Target Multiple	Focus metric	EV Contribution (\$Mn) - 2027	% of Total EV
BTC Mining	EV/EBITDA'27E	5x	\$335Mn Adj. EBITDA	1,673	11%
AI Colocation	1 year fwd EV/EBITDA	21x	\$733Mn Adj. EBITDA	12,317	84%
BTC HODL	Current BTC NAV	\$65K/BTC	11,380 BTC	740	5%

Target EV (\$Mn)	14,730
Less: Net debt (\$Mn)	1,580
Target Market Cap (\$Mn)	13,150
Shares Outstanding (Mn)	378
Target Price (\$/share)	35
Current Price (\$/share)	19
Upside (%)	80%

Source: Company filings, Bernstein estimates and analysis

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 4: RIOT - Financial forecast

(in \$ thousands, except per share)	Dec-25	Dec-26E	Dec-27E		Dec-25	Dec-26E	Dec-27E
Income Statement				Balance Sheet			
Revenue				ASSETS			
Mining	576,276	519,424	748,764	Current assets			
Engineering and Others	71,159	167,182	164,058	Total cash and cash equivalents	309,789	2,075,860	1,331,947
AI Colocation	-	38,423	48,870	Bitcoin	1,575,441	1,707,000	1,567,026
			-	Accounts Receivables (net)	29,788	31,756	38,406
Total Revenue	647,435	725,029	961,693	Prepaid Expenses	59,447	129,926	91,596
				Other current assets	8,308	19,947	19,947
Cost of Revenue				Future Power Credits			
Mining	339,011	330,227	302,492	Total current assets	1,982,773	3,964,490	3,048,922
Engineering and Others	62,864	130,004	115,651	Non current assets			
AI Colocation	-	18,221	4,887	Right of use assets	30,171	42,671	51,867
Total Cost of Revenue	401,875	478,452	423,029	Derivative Asset & Future Power Credits	148,048	88,465	88,465
Gross Profit	245,560	246,577	538,663	Properly, Plant and Equipment, net	1,605,227	1,853,549	3,675,650
SG&A	298,776	318,513	308,998	Intangible assets, net	30,187	26,423	22,659
Dep. & Amortization	346,811	421,820	436,283	Goodwill	122,499	122,499	122,499
Impairment of assets	-	-	-	Other long-term assets	17,862	26,122	26,122
Other Operating Expenses	10,858	88,189	-	Total assets	3,936,767	6,124,219	7,036,184
Total Operating Expenses	656,445	828,522	745,281	LIABILITIES AND STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY			
Power curtailment credits	56,729	61,924	36,707	Current liabilities			
Gain on BTC	35,078	5,146	(11,063)	Contingent consideration liability	6,185	8,195	8,195
				Accounts payable and accrued expenses	203,389	171,224	197,740
Operating Income	(319,078)	(514,875)	(180,973)	Deferred Revenue			
EBITDA	164,302	136,469	375,707	Other current liabilities			
Non-Operating Income			-	Total current liabilities	209,574	179,419	205,935
Interest and other non-operating expense	(193,295)	(33,622)	(158,415)	Lease Liability	25,962	42,671	51,867
Impairment/ Unrealized gain on BTC	(150,958)	634,540	(128,911)	Deferred Revenue, less current portion			10,950
				Contingent consideration liability	2,010		
Pre-Tax Income	(663,331)	86,044	(468,299)	Debt	840,796	2,824,076	4,037,281
Income Tax (Expense)	150	(5,006)	-	Other Long-term liabilities	19	165	165
Income from Continuing Ops-	(663,181)	81,038	(468,299)	Total liabilities	1,078,361	3,046,331	4,306,197
Other comprehensive Income	(222)	-	-	Stockholders' equity			
Net income loss attributable to Riot	(663,403)	81,038	(468,299)	2% Series A convertible preferred stock			
Basic EPS	(1.95)	0.21	(1.24)	0% series B convertible preferred stock			
Cash Flow				Common Stock	4,212,006	4,350,450	4,470,848
Net cash provided by operating activities	29,492	447,852	297,501	Accumulated Deficit	(1,353,600)	(1,272,562)	(1,740,862)
Net cash provided by investing activities	(579,902)	(662,169)	(2,254,619)	Total stockholders' equity	2,858,406	3,077,888	2,729,986
Net cash provided by financing activities	508,898	1,980,389	1,213,205.00	Total liabilities and stockholders' equity	3,936,767	6,124,219	7,036,184
Change in Cash	(41,512)	1,766,071	(743,913)				

Source: Company filings, Bernstein estimates and analysis

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			10 Aug 2026 Closing	Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
RIOT (Riot)	O	USD	19.40	35.00	53.3%	USD	(1.95)	0.21	(1.24)	(10.0)	90.6	(15.7)
OLD				30.00				1.36	(0.77)			
SPX			7,753.11									

PRICE TARGET CHANGE / ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Riot Platforms Inc**

We value RIOT using a SOTP approach - 1. EV of Bitcoin mining business, at ~5x EV/27E' Adjusted EBITDA; 2. Value of Bitcoin holdings at current BTC prices, and (iii) AI infrastructure business at 21x one-year forward EV/EBITDA on steady state CY30E EBITDA (discounted to arrive at target value). We rate RIOT Outperform (PT\$35).

RISKS**Riot Platforms Inc**

Riot's operations are concentrated in Texas. This dependence on Texas could be impacted if there are new laws passed for imposing taxation or preventing mining operations.

Riot's long-term capacity expansion depends on its ability to procure land, equipment and execute the AI contracts in time. Any lag in supply chain or execution delays, could impact its AI pivot.

Riot's operations could face challenges from environmental groups on energy consumption, and its impact on environment.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

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- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
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on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

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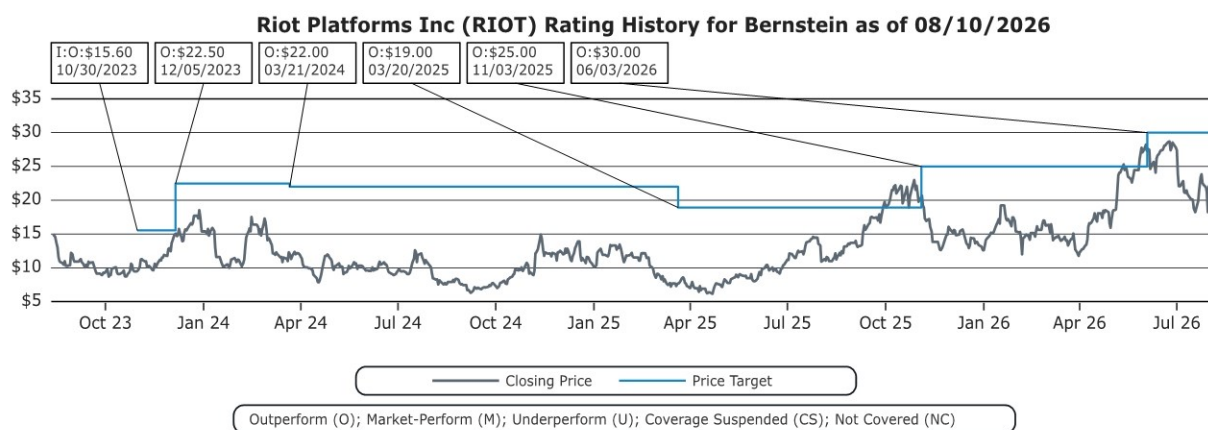
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Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	51.2%	15.3%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

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PRICE CHARTS / RATINGS AND PRICE TARGET HISTORY



All price target and closing price data in the chart(s) above are denominated in the currency noted in the Ticker Table of this report.

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Gautam Chhugani maintains long positions in various crypto currencies.

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